



March 20th Briefing on the Local Response to the Coronavirus Pandemic

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wBlTGdkBQ4g
Publication Date	2020-03-21T00:05:38Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Emergency Management Update: COVID-19 Briefing

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** 00:00:09 Emergency briefing conducted by Jason Rogers, Delaware County Emergency Management Director, broadcasting from the Emergency Operations Center (EOC).
- **Attendance:** Present: Jason Rogers, Delaware County Emergency Management Director. (Other board members or municipal officers not noted in transcript context).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:00:28 Emergency Declaration**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jason Rogers, Emergency Management Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** An emergency declaration has been issued for Delaware County out of an abundance of caution following confirmation of the county's first COVID-19 case (reported late Friday via lab testing for SARS-CoV-2, aligning with statewide case increases reported by the Indiana State Department of Health from

56 to 79 cases). The declaration is designed to address community needs and signal to the state that local assistance is required. By statute, the declaration remains in place automatically for seven days, after which it may be reissued or amended by local jurisdictions.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Administrative declaration enacted (Not a board vote).
- **00:01:43 Travel Guidance & Restrictions**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jason Rogers, Emergency Management Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Clarified that while the state travel map is utilized during snow or ice storms, Delaware County does not currently anticipate using the travel map to restrict travel for COVID-19 unless necessary. Specific guidance will be issued if formal restrictions are enacted. Community cooperation is requested to limit trips to necessary activities only (e.g., medical visits, obtaining food, caring for loved ones/neighbors, work, banking, feeding livestock/animals, and maintaining six-foot social distancing). Supply lines remain active and uninterrupted.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational guidance; cooperation requested.
- **00:03:21 Social Media & Misinformation Alert**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jason Rogers, Emergency Management Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed widespread viral text messages claiming an imminent federal 30-day shutdown, military mobilization for looting/riots, and forced quarantines. Director Rogers verified with Governor Holcomb's prior statements that "we're not there yet" and warned against panic-buying or spreading unverified "friend-of-a-friend" rumors. Residents are advised to maintain standard 72-hour personal preparedness supplies, watch out for fraudulent donation requests, and rely strictly on official channels (local elected officials, state/federal agencies, and the Delaware County COVID-19 Resource Hub).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Public advisory statement.
- **00:07:32 Food Distribution (Points of Distribution / PODs)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jason Rogers, Emergency Management Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** To counteract panic-buying and assist residents facing food access challenges, Emergency Support Functions 6 and 8 have established Points of Distribution (PODs) managed by appointed coordinators.
 - **POD 1:** Saturday morning at 10:00 AM at the Delta High School parking lot.
 - **POD 2:** Thursday, March 26th at the Muncie Mall. Food will be free, pre-packaged, and loaded directly into resident vehicles to maintain safety and efficiency (no need to exit vehicles). Volunteers are urgently needed to help distribute food; interested individuals can sign up via dcema.com under the coronavirus hub.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Operational rollout; volunteer recruitment initiated.
 - **00:09:16 Blood Supply Donations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jason Rogers, Emergency Management Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Partnering with the American Red Cross to maintain regional blood reserves. Residents are urged to visit [RedCrossBlood.org](https://www.redcrossblood.org) to locate active donation sites as additional locations are rolled out.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Public appeal for donations.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Regular updates will continue to be posted on the Delaware County COVID-19 Resource Hub.
 - The next scheduled official briefing message is anticipated for Monday afternoon, unless immediate emergency conditions require earlier announcements.
 - **Adjournment:** Briefing concluded with a call for community patience, solidarity, and adherence to CDC and Indiana State Department of Health guidelines.
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